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A merchant was there with a forked beard, In mottelee and
hye on horse he sat; Upon his head a Flaundrish bever hat...
GEOFFREY CHAUCER, *THE MERCHANT’S TALE*, C.1380
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1101–1200	1201–1210	1211–1300	1301–1359	1360–1380	1381–1449
1150 Horizontal looms, around since the 11th century in Europe and much earlier in the East, become mechanized in the 12th century.	1200s Buttons start to appear in European clothing.  ▲ 13th-century metal button	1215 The Fourth Council of the Lateran rules that Jews and Muslims must be distinguishable by their dress, beginning the process that transformed the conical Jewish hat from something worn as a voluntary mark of difference, to an enforced one. Clerical dress also becomes mandatory.	1350 A fashion for mi-parti or parti-coloured garments made of two contrasting fabrics, one on each side, emerges in the mid-14th century for men.		c.1390 Chaucer's <i>Prologues to The Canterbury Tales</i> includes details of the pilgrims' clothing, showing how medieval people can determine status and position from what someone is wearing.
	1204 The capture of Constantinople in the Fourth Crusade diminishes the power of the Byzantine empire, and its hold on dress style.	 ▲ Map showing Marco Polo's route and the Silk Road		1367 King Richard II of England (reigned 1367–99) is credited with having invented the cloth handkerchief. The item "little pieces [of cloth] for the lord King to wipe and clean his nose", appears in the Household Rolls (accounts) – the first documentation of their use.	
1150 Damask is first produced in the city of Damascus in the 12th century. Damask fabrics rely on contrasting weave textures rather than colour to render patterns.		1271 Venetian Marco Polo sets off on his 24-year-long travels along the Silk Road. His voyage passes through all the centres of silk innovations, manufacture and trading, and he returns to Venice with riches and treasures.	▲ Fitted tunic worn over footed hose 1350 The gown for men is abandoned and instead a tight top over the torso, with breeches or trousers below, is worn. These become the distinctive feature of European men's fashion for centuries to come.	c.1380 Women's shoulders are revealed for the first time in low-necked fitted dresses. Clerics and critics are predictably outraged. They also accuse women of padding their busts to give them a better appearance.	
					▲ Woman in conical headdress c.1430 The headdress in the shape of a cone or "steeple" – the stereotypical princess hat – makes an appearance.
▲ Damask patterned fabric	c.1205 The word "breeches" first appears in the English language.	1278 Velvet is woven in Spain and Italy in the late 13th century. It is documented in 1278 that the English King Edward I has a velvet bed covering.	1351 Edward III of England establishes an embroidery workshop in the Tower of London.		1431 Joan of Arc, the Maid of Orleans claiming divine guidance, leads the French armies to victory against the English. She is burnt as a heretic on 30 May 1431. One of the main charges against her was that she wore male clothing and cut her hair short – transvestitism was against church doctrine.
				▲ The Maid of Orleans	